

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

C	L	O	S	E
W	R	I	T	E

Ladder 2

S	P	A	R	E
S	W	I	F	T

Ladder 3

C	H	E	E	R
T	R	A	C	K

Ladder 4

B	R	U	S	H
G	R	A	S	S

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C	L	O	S	E
C	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	L	E
W	H	I	L	E
W	H	I	T	E
W	R	I	T	E

Ladder 2

S	P	A	R	E
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	I	R	T
S	H	I	F	T
S	W	I	F	T

Ladder 3

C	H	E	E	R
C	H	E	E	K
C	H	E	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	R	I	C	K
T	R	A	C	K

Ladder 4

B	R	U	S	H
C	R	U	S	H
C	R	A	S	H
C	L	A	S	H
C	L	A	S	S
G	L	A	S	S
G	R	A	S	S

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Ladder 1

W	H	E	R	E
W	H	I	L	E

Ladder 2

G	R	A	C	E
T	H	I	N	G

Ladder 3

B	L	A	N	K
C	H	E	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	A	R	K
S	P	O	K	E

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

W	H	E	R	E
T	H	E	R	E
T	H	E	S	E
T	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	L	E
W	H	I	L	E

Ladder 2

G	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	K
T	R	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	N	K
T	H	I	N	G

Ladder 3

B	L	A	N	K
B	L	A	C	K
B	L	O	C	K
C	L	O	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
C	H	E	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	A	R	K
S	H	A	R	E
S	P	A	R	E
S	P	A	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	I	K	E
S	P	O	K	E

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Ladder 1

S	H	O	U	T
S	P	I	C	E

Ladder 2

F	L	O	C	K
T	H	A	N	K

Ladder 3

F	L	I	C	K
S	T	I	L	L

Ladder 4

B	U	N	C	H
P	L	A	T	E

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	H	O	U	T
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
S	P	I	N	E
S	P	I	C	E

Ladder 2

F	L	O	C	K
C	L	O	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	N	K
T	H	A	N	K

Ladder 3

F	L	I	C	K
S	L	I	C	K
S	T	I	C	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	A	L	K
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	I	L	L

Ladder 4

B	U	N	C	H
B	E	N	C	H
B	E	A	C	H
P	E	A	C	H
P	E	A	C	E
P	L	A	C	E
P	L	A	T	E

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Ladder 1

S	L	I	C	E
S	M	A	R	T

Ladder 2

S	C	A	R	Y
S	K	I	R	T

Ladder 3

B	L	A	C	K
C	H	E	E	K

Ladder 4

H	A	R	S	H
P	I	N	C	H

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	L	I	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	A	C	E
S	P	A	R	E
S	T	A	R	E
S	T	A	R	T
S	M	A	R	T

Ladder 2

S	C	A	R	Y
S	C	A	R	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	I	R	T
S	K	I	R	T

Ladder 3

B	L	A	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	L	I	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
C	H	E	C	K
C	H	E	E	K

Ladder 4

H	A	R	S	H
M	A	R	S	H
M	A	R	C	H
M	A	T	C	H
P	A	T	C	H
P	I	T	C	H
P	I	N	C	H

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Ladder 1

S	C	O	U	T
S	P	A	R	K

Ladder 2

S	N	A	K	E
S	P	I	N	E

Ladder 3

P	L	A	N	T
S	T	O	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	E	L	F
S	T	A	T	E

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	C	O	U	T
S	H	O	U	T
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	A	R	K
S	P	A	R	K

Ladder 2

S	N	A	K	E
S	H	A	K	E
S	H	A	D	E
S	P	A	D	E
S	P	A	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	I	N	E

Ladder 3

P	L	A	N	T
P	L	A	N	K
B	L	A	N	K
B	L	A	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	O	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	E	L	F
S	H	E	L	L
S	M	E	L	L
S	M	A	L	L
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	T	E

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Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

C	L	O	C	K
S	H	A	R	P

Ladder 2

S	L	I	M	E
T	R	I	C	K

Ladder 3

S	P	I	L	L
S	T	O	N	E

Ladder 4

B	L	I	N	K
P	E	A	C	H

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C	L	O	C	K
B	L	O	C	K
B	L	A	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	H	A	C	K
S	H	A	R	K
S	H	A	R	P

Ladder 2

S	L	I	M	E
S	L	I	C	E
S	L	I	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	R	I	C	K

Ladder 3

S	P	I	L	L
S	T	I	L	L
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	R	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	O	N	E

Ladder 4

B	L	I	N	K
B	L	A	N	K
P	L	A	N	K
P	L	A	N	E
P	L	A	C	E
P	E	A	C	E
P	E	A	C	H

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Ladder 1

C	L	I	C	K
S	H	A	D	E

Ladder 2

S	H	I	R	T
S	T	A	L	K

Ladder 3

S	C	A	R	F
W	H	I	N	E

Ladder 4

G	R	A	P	H
T	R	U	N	K

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C	L	I	C	K
S	L	I	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	H	A	C	K
S	H	A	R	K
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	A	D	E

Ladder 2

S	H	I	R	T
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	O	R	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	A	R	E
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	K

Ladder 3

S	C	A	R	F
S	C	A	R	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	C	O	N	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	N	E

Ladder 4

G	R	A	P	H
G	R	A	P	E
G	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	K
T	R	U	C	K
T	R	U	N	K

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G	L	I	D	E
S	H	O	C	K

Ladder 2

S	T	A	R	E
W	H	I	T	E

Ladder 3

S	L	A	C	K
S	P	E	L	L

Ladder 4

S	C	E	N	T
S	H	A	P	E

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

G	L	I	D	E
S	L	I	D	E
S	L	I	C	E
S	L	I	C	K
S	T	I	C	K
S	T	O	C	K
S	H	O	C	K

Ladder 2

S	T	A	R	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	O	N	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	T	E

Ladder 3

S	L	A	C	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	A	L	K
S	T	A	L	L
S	M	A	L	L
S	M	E	L	L
S	P	E	L	L

Ladder 4

S	C	E	N	T
S	C	E	N	E
S	C	O	N	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	C	A	R	E
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	A	P	E

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Ladder 1

S	H	O	O	K
S	P	A	C	E

Ladder 2

P	H	O	N	E
S	T	A	C	K

Ladder 3

S	P	I	K	E
W	H	O	S	E

Ladder 4

S	C	O	R	E
S	K	I	L	L

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	H	O	O	K
S	H	O	C	K
S	H	A	C	K
S	H	A	R	K
S	P	A	R	K
S	P	A	R	E
S	P	A	C	E

Ladder 2

P	H	O	N	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	T	O	N	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	O	R	K
S	T	O	C	K
S	T	A	C	K

Ladder 3

S	P	I	K	E
S	P	I	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	L	E
W	H	O	L	E
W	H	O	S	E

Ladder 4

S	C	O	R	E
S	C	A	R	E
S	C	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	I	L	L
S	K	I	L	L

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Ladder 1

S	C	E	N	E
S	T	I	C	K

Ladder 2

S	P	A	D	E
S	T	U	C	K

Ladder 3

G	I	V	E	N
W	I	D	E	R

Ladder 4

G	U	I	D	E
S	H	I	N	E

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	C	E	N	E
S	C	O	N	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	O	R	K
S	T	O	C	K
S	T	I	C	K

Ladder 2

S	P	A	D	E
S	P	A	R	E
S	T	A	R	E
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	U	C	K

Ladder 3

G	I	V	E	N
G	I	V	E	S
D	I	V	E	S
D	I	V	E	R
R	I	V	E	R
R	I	D	E	R
W	I	D	E	R

Ladder 4

G	U	I	D	E
G	L	I	D	E
S	L	I	D	E
S	L	I	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	I	N	E
S	H	I	N	E